

Creative Sound Blaster External USB Sound System

PC Boom-box

performed especially poorly with Indian music-this involves high frequencies. However, it had excellent bass response, and its bass booster and graphic equalizer were accurate at controlling the output.

At a price of only Rs 4,300, you get portability and simplicity. The audio quality

is better than the integrated audio found on most laptops, but desktop users can get a high quality sound card, with far more features, at the same cost. Overall, a great product for laptop users, but desktop users are advised to stick to their onboard six-channel, or opt for a Live series sound card.

WinBackup

An easy to use backup utility

bit encryption standards, as well as password protect your backed up data. WinBackup can be configured to require a log in, so that anybody who wants to use the program has to log in using your password.

You can also configure this utility to back up special files such as your mailbox, My Documents, address book, etc. It also features a search

facility to find backup files, as well as a logging facility. Overall this software showed excellent performance and it does its job of backup and restoration perfectly. The only feature lacking is the ability to automatically back up a file at specific intervals, without user intervention.

UPS

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tracks at random, repeat tracks, play them within a selected group or those with bookmarks, or play selected playlists. The device supports m3u playlists burnt on to MP3 CDs. Depending upon the format of the CD (ATRAC3plus, ATRAC3 or MP3), you can add bookmarks for a fixed number of tracks for up to 10 CDs.

To ensure a skip-free operation, the player has a two-level G-Protection function-one for normal use and the other enhanced level for use while jogging and exercising. This can be controlled from a small switch under the lid of the player, which is slightly inconvenient as you

will have to remove the CD to change the setting.

The device is powered using two AA batteries or the bundled AC adaptor for tethered playback. The player is a hefty bundle to carry around, and there is no carry case provided-there is provision to attach a strap though.

Audio quality is excellent and the bundled stereo earphones reproduce sound with great clarity. However, at Rs 8,000, the device seems a little overpriced, and there are many cheaper options available.

e-Monitor PC Spy

e-Monitor and e-Monitor Pro are PC monitoring software products from Access Online Pvt Ltd. The basic distinction between the products is that e-Monitor only sends an e-mail of reports it generates to the e-mail ID of the administrator, whereas e-Monitor Pro provides an interface through which the system administrator can keep a real-time check on a user's computer.

The programs capture information about running applications, visited websites, files/folder accessed, chat sessions and even print-related activities-such as number of prints, location of prints and the file being printed. It also acts as a key logger, creating detailed reports of every key that was pressed.

Installation of both products is simple and straightforward. For e-Monitor, you need to specify the e-mail ID of the administrator, and for e-Monitor Pro, you need to install the server on the administrator's machine and specify its IP address on each e-Monitor Pro client. An important point to remember is that when you install the product, it asks you for its location, along with the product key and validation key. If you forget the location you won't be able to install the

product again.

You need a username and password to log into the system, after which you get a screen where you can select the report to view. You need to get hold of the username and password separately from Access Online, since they do not disclose it in the documentation.

This product offers all the features that other similar products have, but the pricing isn't competitive with its rivals. However, the version meant for single-user systems has a more competitive price and is definitely a good buy.

System Requirements:
Windows 95/98/Me/NT/2000/XP, Pentium 100 MHz or equivalent, 16 MB RAM, E-mail ID for the Administrator.

Performance: 3.5
Ease of Use: 4
Value of Money: 4
Features: 3
Overall: 3.5
Grade: B+

Price:
e-Monitor Rs 1,950/-
e-Monitor Pro Rs 13,300/- for 5 users
Company: Access Online Pvt Ltd
Phone: 022 - 590 7541
Fax: 022 - 568 4405
E-mail: info@accessonline.com
Web site:
www.accessonline.co.in